PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM, SOAR and EDR/XDR Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of hands-on experience protecting enterprise environments across Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR/XDR), and Privileged Access Management (PAM). In my current role at the University of the Arts London, I lead threat detection and incident response operations for an estate of over 8,000 users, managing tooling that spans CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender, Mimecast, BeyondTrust PAM and Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM). I have strong experience overseeing email and web security gateways, remediating penetration test findings, running enterprise MFA and Single Sign-On (SSO) through Microsoft Entra ID, and delivering security awareness programmes. I thrive in collaborative, fast-paced financial services or professional services environments and am ready to bring immediate value to a small, senior IT security team in the City of London.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and SOAR:** CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Microsoft Defender XDR, SOAR playbook automation, alert triage and tuning
- **EDR and XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI)
- **Email and Web Security Gateways:** Mimecast email security, anti-phishing, DKIM/DMARC, web filtering and content inspection
- **Identity, MFA and SSO:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO) federation, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Device Management:** Microsoft Intune MDM and Mobile Application Management (MAM), endpoint policy enforcement, compliance baselines
- **Vulnerability and Penetration Test Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); remediation tracking and reporting
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework mapping, evidence preservation, post-incident review
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL (Kusto Query Language), SOAR workflow development
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Security Awareness:** Phishing simulation and awareness training programmes (similar to KnowBe4)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead SIEM operations using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, managing alert triage, threat detection rules and SOAR automation across an 8,000-user estate
- Oversee email and web security gateway operations via Mimecast, enforcing anti-phishing policies, DKIM/DMARC and URL rewriting to protect against business email compromise
- Administer EDR and XDR platforms including CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), tuning detection logic and responding to escalated alerts
- Manage enterprise MFA, SSO and Conditional Access policies through Microsoft Entra ID, reducing identity-based attack surface across all user and privileged accounts
- Oversee BeyondTrust PAM implementation, governing privileged account lifecycle, session recording and least-privilege enforcement
- Direct vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera BAS; track and report on remediation of penetration test findings to senior management

- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulations to staff, measuring click rates and improving security culture across faculties
- Respond to and lead incident response investigations using the NIST 800-61 framework, coordinating cross-functional teams and producing post-incident reports
- Manage Intune MDM and MAM policies for Windows, macOS, iOS and Android endpoints, enforcing compliance and encryption standards
- Maintain Check Point Harmony firewall policies and Tanium endpoint management, ensuring consistent security baselines

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Performed daily alert triage and investigation across SIEM, EDR and email security platforms, escalating confirmed incidents to senior engineers and tracking resolution
- Supported deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Defender across the full endpoint estate, including policy configuration and exclusion management
- Assisted in managing MFA and Conditional Access rollouts through Microsoft Entra ID, contributing to Cyber Essentials Plus accreditation
- Conducted vulnerability scans using Nessus and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports for infrastructure and application teams
- Supported BeyondTrust PAM onboarding for privileged accounts, configuring session policies and audit trails
- Participated in tabletop exercises and simulated incident response scenarios, improving SOC readiness
- Created and maintained SIEM detection rules and dashboards, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for high-severity alerts

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Implemented and maintained endpoint security controls and email gateway configuration for a cloud-first SaaS platform serving enterprise procurement clients
- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender and Azure Active Directory (now Entra ID) with MFA and Conditional Access for remote workforce
- Performed infrastructure vulnerability assessments and tracked remediation against CIS Controls and ISO 27001 requirements
- Supported SOC 2 Type II audit preparation, documenting security controls and providing evidence for access management, logging and monitoring
- Automated routine security hygiene tasks using PowerShell scripts, reducing manual overhead for patching and compliance reporting

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led deployment of CrowdStrike Falcon across an 8,000-user endpoint estate at UAL, reducing mean time to contain (MTTC) for endpoint threats by over 60%
- Built and tuned over 40 custom SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, cutting false-positive alert volumes by approximately 35%
- Designed and implemented BeyondTrust PAM governance framework covering 300+ privileged accounts, eliminating standing administrative access
- Directed UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus recertification, coordinating remediation across network, identity and endpoint domains
- Delivered enterprise-wide phishing simulation campaign achieving a 55% improvement in staff reporting rates over 12 months
- Automated vulnerability report generation and ticket creation using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel SOAR playbooks, saving approximately 8 hours per week of analyst time

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)